Data Retention & Deletion Schedule

Ref: 4.3
Product: iConnect Plus
Organisation: Cache Digitech
Classification: Internal — Confidential
Version: 2.0
Date: 2026-11-03
Deployment model: On-premises (Cache Digitech premises) · VPN for remote access
Audience: Legal, DPO, platform engineering, auditors

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1. Purpose

Define **retention windows**, **purge mechanisms**, and **deletion semantics** (soft delete vs hard purge) for iConnect Plus data on on-premises PostgreSQL and related stores.

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2. Principles

Principle	Implementation
Business records	Soft delete on transactional tables — no physical DELETE in normal operations
Legal / audit hold	Suspend purge when hold flag/process active — **Template / Pending sign-off**
Automated purge	Celery jobs: `platform.outbox_purge`, `platform.retention_purge`
Tenant isolation	Purge scoped by tenant where applicable

Authoritative retention constants: `apps/api/src/modules/platform/retention.py` — `RETENTION_DAYS`.

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3. Platform retention schedule

Class key	Retention	Applies to	Purge mechanism
`operational`	**3 years** (1095 days)	Default soft-deleted operational rows	Domain jobs / future automation — **Template / Pending sign-off** per table
`audit`	**10 years** (3650 days)	Audit log and audit-class records	Archive then purge policy **Template / Pending sign-off**
`notification`	**1 year** (365 days)	`NtfEvent` and similar	`platform.retention_purge`
`outbox_processed`	**90 days**	Processed outbox rows	`platform.outbox_purge`
`session`	**30 days**	Session / refresh cleanup window	Session service + scheduled cleanup

Additional platform purges (same job family):

Artifact	Retention	Task
Idempotency records	30 days	`platform.retention_purge`
Job run history	90 days	`platform.retention_purge`

4. Module-specific retention

Domain	Policy	SSOT
Document management	Per `DocRetentionPolicy` (tenant-configurable days)	Document module + migrations
HR / finance / payroll	Operational + statutory — align with 3y/10y classes	Module owners + legal
Logs (application)	≥ **180 days** on-prem	See 5.1

Document module example seed uses long retention (e.g. 2555 days) for demo policies — production values are tenant-defined.

5. Deletion types

Type	Description	User-visible
Soft delete	`is_deleted`, `deleted_at`, `deleted_by`	Hidden from default lists; recoverable per module
Hard purge	Physical row removal after retention cutoff	Not reversible
Object delete	MinIO object removal after document retention/archive	Per document workflow

6. Data subject / erasure requests (DPDP)

Step	Action	Owner
Intake	Ticket to DPO / admin	**Template / Pending sign-off** PoC
Verify identity	Tenant admin or DPO process	Tenant admin
Execute	Soft delete + anonymize fields where erasure required	Platform + module owner
Evidence	Record in processing register (4.5)	DPO

Statutory retention may **override** erasure for finance/audit classes — legal review required.

7. Backup retention

Backup copies inherit source classification. Backup retention period: **Template / Pending sign-off** (recommended ≤ operational retention unless legal hold). See **4.4**.

8. Schedule review

Activity	Frequency	Next due
Retention constant review vs law	Annual	**Template / Pending sign-off**
Purge job success monitoring	Daily	**Template / Pending sign-off**
Restore sample after purge	Annual	**Template / Pending sign-off**

9. Related documents

Ref	Document
4.1	Data Inventory & Classification
4.4	Backup & Restore Procedure

4.5	Personal Data Processing Record
5.1	Logging & Monitoring Specification

10. Change log

Date	Change	By
2026-11-03	v2.0 aligned to `RETENTION_DAYS`	Platform

Legal sign-off: Template / Pending sign-off